

Day 76 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Economy & TN Dev. Admin. (4): India's 2026 Free Trade Agreements

READING MATERIAL

Covers 3 major Free Trade Agreements India concluded in 2026 — its most active year yet for trade diplomacy.

Q: What major trade agreement did India conclude with the EU, and when?

A: The India-EU Free Trade Agreement, announced 27 January 2026 — after nearly two decades of negotiations. Nicknamed the 'mother of all deals' for its scale.

Q: How large is the India-EU FTA's combined market, and what share of global GDP does it represent?

A: It covers about 2 billion people, with a combined market value of nearly \$27 trillion — about 25% of global GDP.

Q: What tariff relief does the India-EU FTA give Indian exporters, and which Indian sectors benefit most?

A: The EU will eliminate tariffs on 90% of Indian goods immediately (rising to 93% within 7 years). Sectors benefiting with zero tariffs immediately: seafood, chemicals, plastics, leather, textiles, apparel, metals, and gems/jewellery.

Q: Which historically protected Indian sector is opening up under the India-EU FTA, and by how much?

A: The automobile sector — tariffs cut from up to 110% down to 30-35% initially, phasing down further to 10% over time.

Q: What trade agreement did India sign with New Zealand, and when?

A: India and New Zealand signed a Free Trade Agreement on 27 April 2026, giving Indian exporters full duty-free access to the New Zealand market upon entry into force.

Q: What tariff change did the US-India trade deal (announced 2 February 2026) bring?

A: US tariffs on Indian goods were cut from a punitive 50% down to a consolidated 18%.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The India-EU Free Trade Agreement was announced on:

A. 27 January 2026 ✓

B. 27 February 2026

C. 27 March 2026

D. 27 April 2026

Explanation: 27 January 2026. [medium, web-research]

2. The India-EU FTA's combined market represents approximately what share of global GDP?

A. 10%

B. 15%

C. 20%

D. 25% ✓

Explanation: About 25% of global GDP. [hard, web-research]

3. Under the India-EU FTA, India's automobile sector tariffs (previously up to 110%) are being cut initially to:

A. 10%

B. 20%

C. 30-35% ✓

D. 50%

Explanation: 30-35% initially, phasing down to 10% over time. [hard, web-research]

4. India signed a Free Trade Agreement with New Zealand on:

A. 27 January 2026

B. 2 February 2026

C. 27 April 2026 ✓

D. 5 June 2026

Explanation: 27 April 2026. [medium, web-research]

5. The US-India trade deal (announced 2 February 2026) cut US tariffs on Indian goods from 50% to:

A. 10%

B. 18% ✓

C. 25%

D. 30%

Explanation: 18%. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Puzzles

READING MATERIAL

Puzzles is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills. The genre overlaps with Logical Reasoning, so this topic focuses on archetypes NOT already covered there: comparison chains, age puzzles, family-relation puzzles, and linear seating arrangements — all extremely common TNPSC puzzle shapes.

Q: Method — comparison chain (not all four compared directly, must chain through clues): D is taller than C but not as tall as B. C is taller than A. Who is the tallest?

A: Chain it: $B > D > C > A$. So B is the tallest. The key technique: write each clue as an inequality, then merge them into one ordered chain rather than trying to compare all pairs mentally.

Q: Method — classic age puzzle: A father is 4 times as old as his son. In 20 years, he will be twice as old as his son. Find their current ages.

A: Let son's current age = x , father = $4x$. In 20 years: father = $4x+20$, son = $x+20$. Condition: $4x+20 = 2(x+20) \rightarrow 4x+20 = 2x+40 \rightarrow 2x=20 \rightarrow x=10$. Son is 10, father is 40.

Q: Method — family-relation puzzle: Pointing to a photograph, a man says, 'She is the daughter of my mother's only son.' How is the woman in the photo related to the man?

A: His daughter. 'My mother's only son' = the man himself (since he's referring to his own mother, and he's an only son). So 'her father' = the man, making the woman his daughter.

Q: Method — linear seating arrangement: Five friends P, Q, R, S, T sit in a row. Q is immediately to the right of P. R is at one end. S is between Q and T. T is not adjacent to P. Find the order.

A: Work from the most fixed clue first: R is at an end — try R at the left end. P-Q must be adjacent with Q right of P, and S is between Q and T, with T not adjacent to P. Testing R,P,Q,S,T: P-Q adjacent ✓, S between Q&T ✓, T not adjacent to P (T is at position 5, P at position 2, not adjacent) ✓, R at an end ✓. Order: R, P, Q, S, T.

Q: Method — distribution/sharing puzzle: A sum of money is divided among A, B, and C so that A gets twice as much as B, and B gets thrice as much as C. If C gets ₹600, find the total sum.

A: $C=600$. $B=3 \times 600=1800$. $A=2 \times 1800=3600$. Total = $3600+1800+600 = 6000$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. P is shorter than Q but taller than R. Q is shorter than S. Who is the tallest?

- A. P
- B. Q
- C. R
- D. S ✓**

Explanation: Chain: $S > Q > P > R$. S is tallest. [medium, authored]

2. A mother is 3 times as old as her daughter. In 15 years, she will be twice as old as her daughter. Find the daughter's current age.

- A. 10
- B. 12
- C. 15 ✓**
- D. 18

Explanation: Daughter= x , mother= $3x$. $3x+15=2(x+15) \rightarrow 3x+15=2x+30 \rightarrow x=15$. [medium, authored]

3. Pointing to a man, a woman says, 'He is the son of my father's only daughter.' If the woman has no siblings, how is the man related to her?

- A. Her son ✓**
- B. Her brother
- C. Her nephew
- D. Her father

Explanation: 'My father's only daughter' = the woman herself (she has no siblings). So the man is her son. [medium, authored]

4. ₹7,000 is divided among A, B, C so that A gets twice as much as B, and B gets twice as much as C. Find C's share.

- A. ₹1,000 ✓**
- B. ₹1,200

C. ₹1,500

D. ₹2,000

Explanation: Let $C=x$, $B=2x$, $A=4x$. $\text{Total}=7x=7000 \rightarrow x=1,000$. [medium, authored]

5. Four friends sit in a row. B is immediately right of A. C is at the left end. D is not adjacent to A. Find the correct order.

A. C, A, B, D ✓

B. A, B, C, D

C. C, D, A, B

D. D, A, B, C

Explanation: C at left end; A-B adjacent with B right of A; D not adjacent to A. Order C,A,B,D satisfies all three conditions. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Grammar: Sentence Types and Transformations

READING MATERIAL

Covers converting between the 4 sentence types (statement/declarative, interrogative, imperative, exclamatory) and related transformations (assertive↔negative-equivalent, assertive↔imperative).

Q: Real exam: convert the interrogative 'Is she not changing her dress?' into a statement.

A: She is not changing her dress. (A negative interrogative converts to a plain negative statement, keeping the same tense — don't flip it to a positive statement.)

Q: Real exam: transform 'He is too shrewd to be cheated' into a negative-equivalent sentence.

A: He is so shrewd that he cannot be cheated. ('too...to' restructures to 'so...that...cannot', preserving the original meaning exactly — not weakening it to 'not too shrewd'.)

Q: Real exam: convert the exclamatory 'Had she known it earlier!' into an assertive sentence.

A: I wish she had known it earlier. (This exclamatory form — an inverted conditional expressing regret — converts to an assertive 'I wish...' statement, not a plain factual statement like 'She knew it earlier'.)

Q: Real exam: which of these is an imperative sentence — 'Who are you?' / 'How did you explain this question?' / 'Clean your room' / 'What a great statue!'?

A: 'Clean your room' — a command/request, with no stated subject (the subject 'you' is implied).

Q: Real exam: 'Let my head be shattered to pieces' is what type of sentence?

A: Imperative sentence — 'Let...' constructions expressing a wish/command (despite sounding dramatic/exclamatory) are classified as imperative in this exam's pattern.

Q: Real exam: transform the assertive 'You should answer all the questions' into an imperative sentence.

A: Answer all the questions. (Drop the subject 'you' and the modal 'should', keep just the base-form verb command.)

Q: Real exam: transform the imperative 'Give me a book' into an appreciative statement.

A: I appreciate you giving a book. (An 'appreciative statement' transformation expresses gratitude/appreciation for the action, distinct from a plain 'Thank you for...' — both can sound plausible, so match the exact phrasing style asked for.)

Q: Real exam (flagged by TNPSC itself as sent to its expert committee for final decision — included with that caveat): the interrogative form of 'You have to be there on Monday' was marked as:

A: Will you be there on Monday? (NOTE: this exact item's answer was itself flagged as disputed/under review in the source answer key — a reminder that even official answer keys sometimes have contested items; don't treat every 'marked' answer as infallible.)

Q: Convert into a statement: 'What a beautiful painting!'

A: It is a beautiful painting. ('What a/an + adjective + noun!' converts to 'It is a/an + adjective + noun.')

Q: Convert into a statement: 'How sweet the mango is!'

A: The mango is very sweet. ('How + adjective + subject + is!' converts to '[Subject] is very + adjective.' — note the added 'very', which is the standard pattern for this conversion.)

Q: Convert the imperative 'Please sit down' into an interrogative.

A: Can you sit down? (Polite imperative → 'Can/Will you...?' request-question form.)

Q: Convert the imperative 'Be quiet' into an interrogative.

A: Will you be quiet? (Direct imperative → 'Will you...?' form — note this differs slightly from the 'Can you...?' pattern used for 'Please sit down', so match the exact style of the original imperative.)

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Convert into a statement: 'Is she not changing her dress?'

- A. She will not change her dress.
- B. She was not changing her dress.
- C. She will change her dress.

D. She is not changing her dress. ✓

Explanation: She is not changing her dress. [medium, question-bank-2025]

2. Transform into a negative-equivalent sentence: 'He is too shrewd to be cheated.'

- A. He is not shrewd enough to be cheated.
- B. He is so shrewd that he cannot be cheated. ✓**
- C. He is not too shrewd to be cheated.
- D. He is shrewd.

Explanation: He is so shrewd that he cannot be cheated. [hard, question-bank-2025]

3. Convert the exclamatory sentence 'Had she known it earlier!' into an assertive sentence.

- A. She knew it earlier.
- B. I wish she had known it earlier. ✓**
- C. Knowing this earlier is beneficial.
- D. She should have known it earlier.

Explanation: I wish she had known it earlier. [hard, question-bank-2025]

4. Which of the following is an imperative sentence?

- A. Who are you?
- B. How did you explain this question?
- C. Clean your room. ✓**
- D. What a great statue!

Explanation: Clean your room. [easy, question-bank-2025]

5. 'Let my head be shattered to pieces' is an:

- A. Interrogative sentence
- B. Affirmative sentence
- C. Imperative sentence ✓**
- D. Exclamatory sentence

Explanation: Imperative sentence. [medium, question-bank-2025]

6. Transform into an imperative sentence: 'You should answer all the questions.'

- A. Should you answer all the questions?
- B. Answer all the questions. ✓**
- C. You answer all the questions.
- D. All questions should be answered.

Explanation: Answer all the questions. [medium, question-bank-2025]

7. Transform the imperative 'Give me a book' into an appreciative statement.

- A. I'm glad that you have given a book.
- B. Thank you for giving a book.
- C. I appreciate you giving a book. ✓**
- D. Why do you not give a book?

Explanation: I appreciate you giving a book. [hard, question-bank-2025]

8. Convert into a statement: 'What a beautiful painting!'

- A. The painting is beautiful.
- B. It is a beautiful painting. ✓**
- C. That is a beautiful painting.
- D. How beautiful the painting is!

Explanation: It is a beautiful painting. [easy, web-research]

9. Convert into a statement: 'How sweet the mango is!'

- A. The mango is sweet.
- B. It is very sweet.
- C. The mango is very sweet. ✓**
- D. How mango is sweet!

Explanation: The mango is very sweet. [medium, web-research]

10. Convert the imperative 'Please sit down' into an interrogative.

- A. Why don't you sit down?

B. Can you sit down? ✓

C. Do you sit down?

D. Should you sit down?

Explanation: Can you sit down? [easy, web-research]

11. Convert the imperative 'Be quiet' into an interrogative.

A. Why not be quiet?

B. Are you being quiet?

C. Can't you be quiet?

D. Will you be quiet? ✓

Explanation: Will you be quiet? [medium, web-research]